BENJAMIN PACINI

TEACHER. INNOVATOR. LEADER.

CONTACT

801.618.7865

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sites.google.com/view/benjamin-pacini

673 Johnson Street Rexburg, ID 83440

SKILLS

Teacher, communicator, and writer

Researcher, thinker, and analyst

Leader, evaluator, and manager

Innovator, problem solver, idea generator

EDUCATION

Doctorate in Education Leadership

Brigham Young University

3.89 GPA April 2025

Master's of Science in Education

Johns Hopkins University

3.75 GPA. Graduated 2013.

Bachelor's of Arts in Economics

Brigham Young University

3.7 GPA. Graduated 2010.

LANGUAGES

English

Spanish

Italian

PROFILE

Passionate and innovative educator with 10 years of experience in high-poverty schools as a middle school math teacher, content lead, and assistant principal and an additional 5 years in higher education. University faculty focused on evidence-based practice and teacher excellence. Focused on results, including student achievement, behavior, and school climate and culture. Writer, communicator, and podcaster featured in Deseret News, Real Clear Politics, Real Clear Religion, and Public Square Magazine.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Faculty

Brigham Young University - Idaho — 2020 - Present
Department of Elementary, Early, and Special Education

- Course Lead and Teacher: ED 304: EdPsych and Human Development.
  - A course concerned with how the brain learns, evidence-based practice, human development, and other topics in psychology. We briefly touch on student mental health, research methods, and the foundations of classroom management.
- Course Lead and Teacher: ED 449: Senior Practicum.
  - The course immediately preceding student teaching in which students teach half-time in schools under the guidance of a mentor teacher. I teach during a once-per-week seminar, and I observe students throughout the semester. Students must pass a Danielson summative evaluation, complete a unit plan, present a senior portfolio with formal interview, and be successfully rated in the dispositions required to be a successful teacher.
- Course Lead and Teacher: ED 361: Principles of Teaching and Assessment.
  - An introductory course in the foundations of designing effective instruction, including lesson planning, design of assessments, unpacking standards, and measuring learning.
- Teacher: ECON 150, Microeconomics
  - Introductory microeconomics course focused on principles of supply and demand, elasticity, welfare analysis, firm models under competition and market power, market failures, and policy analysis.
- Teacher: ED 246. Classroom Leadership and Motivation
  - An introductory course in classroom management, teacher presence, and motivational techniques. Required assignments include a classroom management plan and responses to case study examples.
- Teacher: ED 211. Educational Technology for the 21st Century.
  - A course on innovation and edtech. Each week consists of two major assignments: a project, built by students using a new EdTech tool to be used in teaching, and a set of readings and discussions meant to build innovative intuitions and healthy mindsets about classroom use of technology and evidence-based practice.
- Teacher: ED 200: Teaching as a Profession.
  - This is an introductory course into the profession of teaching focusing on the history and philosophy of education, evidence-based practice, and an outline of the requirements necessary to be an effective teacher.
- Additional contributions to community:
  - Advisor: Elementary, Early, and Special Education Academic Society.
  - Author of multiple articles in campus magazine: Perspectives.
  - Brown Bag Lunch Facilitator: Belonging at BYU-Idaho.
  - Coordinated BYU Master's in Policy trip for 5 education students
  - Author of various blogs on BYUI teaching and learning site.
  - Initiated/coordinated campus-wide Russia/Ukraine forum discussion.
  - Volunteer Math Praxis tutor.
  - Co-President of 2020 cohort of new faculty.

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SOCIAL MEDIA

twitter.com/benjaminpacini

facebook.com/benjaminpacini

linkedin.com/in/benjamin-pacini-5161a512/

benjaminpacini.substack.com

skepticaleducator.substack.com/

sites.google.com/view/benjamin-pacini

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Validity of teacher testing, licensure, and certification as related to student achievement.
- Teacher preparation program (TPP) improvement.
- Social media, wellness, disinformation, misinformation, and mental health.
- The research-to-implementation gap and credential-fueled misinformation (i.e. learning styles)
- Value-added modeling (VAM) for both students and TPPs, and validity of VAM for life outcomes.
- School choice and student outcomes; information assymetry in education markets.
- Teacher labor markets and choice effects on teacher well-being.
- School climate and culture; student behavior, suspensions, expulsions.
- Employee misbehavior in education

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- Math Teaching
- Ed Leadership
- School Culture
- Teacher Obs/Eval
- Educational Tech
- Hiring and Mgmt.
- Inst. Coaching
- Academic Research
- Communication

WORK EXPERIENCE

Assistant Principal of Math

Washington D.C. Public Schools: 2016-2020
Brightwood Education Campus

- Increased math PARCC proficiency levels by 12%+ over two years (double the DCPS average) in a school with 100% poverty, and 50%+ EL students
- Led School Climate Committee: Formulated long-term plan; Student satisfaction index remained above 80%, adult culture (Insight scores) nearly doubled, and suspensions decreased significantly, after an initial increase
- Led all math instruction and coaching at Brightwood, including curriculum (Eureka), online supports (iReady, TenMarks, IXL, etc.) and assessment (PARCC, iReady). Led "LEAP" coaching teams.
- Supported Flamboyan home visit initiative; 70%+ of our families received home visit in SY 16-17 & 17-18.

Math Content Lead and Middle School Math Teacher

Baltimore City Public Schools 2013-2016
KIPP Ujima Village Academy

- Math Content Leader: Led math team in goal setting, accountability, and professional development; Assisted in implementation of online math programs for 1-to-1 Chromebook program.
- Assessment & Data Coordinator: Led roll out of school-wide grade book and the assessment program Illuminate; Supervised all school-wide standardized testing, including MAP and MSA;
- Math Teacher: Used formative assessments (e.g. MobyMax's Grade Level score—2.7 years of class average growth), growth assessments (such as NWEA's MAP test—1.66 years of growth in a cohort) and summative assessments (PARCC) measure/accelerate performance
- Led "Good Man Club" (GMC) for 20 young men, which included team-building, character-building, and positive social interaction

Middle School Math Teacher

2010-2013
Baltimore City Public Schools:
Holabird Academy

- Director, After School and Saturday School Programs: Led 80-student after school enrichment and tutoring programs while overseeing $20,000 budget and 8 staff, including student discipline, staff development and basic payroll
- Administered program which led to increased math scores for 6th grade math students, including hundreds of hours of extra math practice on ixl.com
- Math Teacher, 6th-8th Grade: Increased 6th grade proficiency rates from 40% to 80% on Maryland State Assessment year-over-year.
- Visited nearly 30 homes as part of school home visit initiative

Other Leadership Experiences

Various 2010-2020

- Washington D.C. Public Schools: Summer School Administrator
- Baltimore City Public Schools: District Headquarters CEO Fellowship Intern
- Baltimore City Public Schools: Westport Summer School academic director.
- Baltimore City Public Schools: Holabird Academy Saturday Academy director.
- Baltimore City Public Schools: Holabird Academy Summer School director.

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PUBLISHED VENUES

Public Square Magazine

Deseret News

Real Clear Politics

Real Clear Religion

WRITING INTERESTS

- Belonging, inclusion, and unity
- Group psychology
- Tribes, tribalism, and psychology
- Positive masculinity
- Parenting and social media
- School choice and education reform
- Civility, peacemaking, and civic virtues
- Religious freedom and pluralism
- Economics, politics, and public policy
- The mental health crisis
- Economics, debt limits, and fiscal conservatism
- Classical liberal and enlightenment thought
- Religious freedom
- Current events
- All things related to The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints
- Higher education reform
- Innovation in education
- Evidence-based practice
- Family policy

REFERENCES

Jeff Pulsipher

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Laorangek@byui.edu

WRITING, PODCASTING, COMMUNICATING

Writer, Producer, and Podcaster

Public Square Magazine 2020-Present

- Host and producer of Radical Civility, a podcast about civility, peacemaking, current events, and dialog. Flagship podcast of Public Square Magazine, and featured in Real Clear Religion.
- Staff writer for Public Square Magazine; Freelance writer at other venues. Essays have been featured in Real Clear Politics, Real Clear Religion, Deseret News, and regularly at Public Square Magazine.

Academic Research

- Dissertation: The Crystal Ball is Cloudy. TPP Challenges in Identifying High-Quality Teachers from Student Characteristics. December 2024.
  - **Abstract:** Teacher Preparation Programs (TPPs) stand to benefit if they can reliably predict which education students will make for strong or weak teachers—for example, by better supporting underperformers and spotting high-potential candidates early. Current metrics rely heavily on academic measures like ACT or GPA rather than indicators of actual teaching quality, however. In this study, I analyze data from a university in the Mountain West to explore the statistical relationships between pre-college student characteristics and teaching evaluation scores during student teaching, using Danielson's Framework for Teaching (FFT). My findings suggest that such relationships are elusive: no significant relationship exists between FFT scores and demographic characteristics such as age, sex, marital status, or poverty. Pre-college academic variables (i.e., GPA and standardized test scores) show small but positive relationships with FFT scores. Additionally, pre-service teachers in secondary education majors (e.g., secondary math, music education) receive evaluation scores between 3% and 7% of a standard deviation lower on average than elementary, special education, and early childhood majors across FFT sub-domains. Overall, these results caution against overreliance on academic variables as indicators of future teaching success. They also suggest that a small portion of TPPs' contribution to teacher quality is attributable to student characteristics rather than program value-added.

CIVIC, VOLUNTEER, AND LEADERSHIP

Religious and Civic Contributions

Henderson 1st Ward, Rexburg, Idaho Center Stake 2020-2025
The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

- Elders' Quorum 2nd Counselor: Assisted adult men's group leadership with well-being of congregation, teaching, service, etc.
- Stake Sunday School President: Responsible for improving religious instruction.

Savage Mill Ward, Jessup, MD 2010-2020
The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

- Participant in ministering (Christian service) programs in local congregations
- Boy Scouts merit badge counselor for Citizenship in the World merit badge.
- Primary-aged children music leader.
- Congregation-level leader; 2nd Counselor to local bishop.

Missionary: Texas, Houston South Mission 2005-2007
The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

- Taught religious principles, engaged in service, and taught English.
- Supported local community congregations.
- Mentored other missionaries, and served in mission leadership.

Eagle Scout: Boy Scouts of America 1999
Great Salt Lake Basin

- Gold palm, senior patrol leader.

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TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN,

I am a teacher. Why?

I'll begin with the personal payoffs. Teaching is drenched in satisfaction and meaning. Teaching changes me. Teaching is the most challenging thing I can imagine. It, therefore, has the highest payoff. I am a teacher because it is profoundly rewarding to me in a dozen ways that link to meaning, purpose, character, and the person I've become.

My professional career has been one of good luck and good options. I could opt for comfortable and well-paying--and, indeed, I'm fortunate to have always had enough for my family. But given the choice, I've been found something far more valuable: a job that gets me out of bed in the morning. A job that is filled with purpose, meaning, and the benefit of people other than me. My work has been in poverty-stricken areas of Baltimore and Washington D.C. The challenge and the satisfaction are not obstacles, they are in large measure what drive me.

Secondly, I am a teacher because I want to be a helper. Adam Smith has observed that "Man naturally desires, not only to be loved, but to be lovely." There is a difference between wanting to be *perceived* as a helper, and actuall doing some good in the world. I won't complain about the former, but my profound desire is for the latter. After tasting this kind of goodness as a missionary--the soul-level good that you can do by serving and lifting your fellowmen--I had a hard time imagining that I would ever find something sufficiently helpful to occupy my professional life. Now I know better. Teaching is an approximation of that service, but it is a good one. I am ambitious. I want to be perceived as a helper. But when I strip all of that away, what drives me is ambition to do good in the world--not position or title. I want to actually help.

I want to teach so that I can give kids options: so that they can choose their own life and what it will be. I want them to be protected from chaos and built strong enough to withstand the storms of life. In this season of my career, I am not in K-12 schools. That is hard for me. I console myself knowing that I am trading the chance to impact 30 students deeply with the chance to raise an army of teachers that will make a difference in the lives of students.

Thirdly, I am a teacher because I am a teacher. John the apostle writes that "we love Him because He first loved us." There are some things that we do because they are a part of us in ways that defy description. I could no more stop teaching than I could stop being tall or having blue eyes. This is who I am. There is joy in "living authentically," and I am one of the lucky few who get to.

Finally, I teach because it is in my DNA--and yours--to seek light. That light is irresistible--and I find that it shines most brilliantly in the exercise of teaching.

BENJAMIN PACINI
REXBURG, IDAHO DEC 2024

